



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Sacred Heart Schools
School Website: <https://www.shschools.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report**

Executive Summary - School: Austin Classical School (ACS) - Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/> - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: ACS explicitly centers its mission on cultivating wisdom and virtue ordered to the true, the good, and the beautiful; integrates Christian theology across the curriculum; employs the Trivium with Latin, logic, and rhetoric; features memory, singing/chanting, debate/discussion, and oratory; positions teachers as formational models; and operates a collaborative schedule that treats parents as co-teachers. Evidence appears across mission, academics, and community pages, and strongly aligns with the positive indicators in the “Six Essential Elements” keyword lexicon used for this audit. - Notable insights: - ACS states its aim is “to cultivate wisdom and virtue” through contemplation of truth, goodness, and beauty, and distinguishes itself from a “traditional college preparatory institution” whose primary aim is college placement; ACS’s goal is “life,” not merely “college”. - Religious and liturgical life is explicit (Christ-centered, chapel, prayer; instruction “rooted” in the Statement of Faith; integration “under the sovereignty of God through theology”). - Pedagogy highlights memory, recitation, songs and chants; debate/discussion (logic); rhetoric culminating in thesis defense and eloquent speech; community Recitatio event.

Note on method: This audit follows the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” positive/negative keyword indicators and the classicality lexicon provided, applied across six categories: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community. Each category lists the school’s onsite keywords/phrases, compares them to the provided lexicon, offers a quantitative positive/negative estimate, and justifies the rating.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS 1) On-site keyword findings - “Christ-centered” and “Biblical truth” (ACCS accreditation note) - “Glorify Jesus Christ ... classical, Christian education” (mission) - “All School chapel” for visitors; tours begin with chapel attendance - Instruction “consistent with and rooted in [our Statement of Faith]” - “Interrelatedness of all knowledge under the sovereignty of God through theology” - “Offer the work of the school as a prayer to Almighty God”

2) Comparison to keyword lists

- Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; faith and reason; chapel/worship; prayer; Christ-centered; liturgical/communal practices – all strongly affirmed in the lexicon for Religious/Metaphysical (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; chapel; reverence/prayer) and “Six Elements” (Transcendental Moral Realism; Grounded in Theology; Liturgical and Communal Practices).
- Negative indicators (e.g., values-neutral, secular, relativist) are absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 10 (Christ-centered, Jesus Christ, chapel, prayer, theology, sovereignty of God, Biblical, truth/goodness/beauty, faith language, rooted in Statement of Faith)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage of sub-elements (moral realism, theology, liturgy): $3/3 = 1.00$

4) Rating: CLASSICAL



CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL 1) On-site keyword findings - “Aim: To cultivate wisdom and virtue ... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” - “Our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life” (rejects college-prep as telos) - “Helping form the souls of our children ... pointed to the good, true, and beautiful” (formation emphasis)

2) Comparison to keyword lists

- Positive matches: cultivate wisdom and virtue; truth, goodness, beauty; formation not information – all canonical indicators for purpose/goal.
- Rejects “college and career readiness” as primary goal (negative indicator) by explicit contrast.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 8
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage (virtue/wisdom; TGB; formation): $3/3 = 1.00$

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM 1) On-site keyword findings - Trivium—Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; explicit stage descriptions; thesis defense in Rhetoric - Latin (5th–8th), formal logic (8th), rhetoric (10th) - Great Books/Great Conversation language; integrated curriculum; “interrelation of all knowledge ... under ... theology” - History, Bible, art, music included (broad liberal arts emphasis) - Wonder language: “stir the heart ... curiosity ... passion for learning”

2) Comparison to keyword lists

- Positive matches: trivium/quadrivium framework (Trivium explicit), Latin/logic/rhetoric, Great Books/-Great Conversation, integrated curriculum, wonder – all direct positives in “Six Elements” and lexicon.
- Negative signals (e.g., “social studies” replacing “history,” STEM-first, project-based dominance) are absent.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 12
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage (Trivium, Great Books/History, Integration, Wonder): $4/4 = 1.00$

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS 1) On-site keyword findings - Grammar years: “engaging memory work, songs and chants” (singing/chanting; memorization/recitation) - Logic years: “debate and discussion” (dialectic) - Rhetoric years: “Thesis defense and eloquent written and oral communication” (rhetoric/oratory) - Community Recitatio (public recitation/memory work showcase) - Note: “Socratic” and “scholé” not explicitly named on site; however, the practices align with debate/discussion and restful pacing (regulated academic load). No heavy “project-based/experiential” marketing is evident.

2) Comparison to keyword lists

- Positive matches to pedagogy lexicon: chanting/singing; memorization/recitation; debate/discussion; rhetoric/oratory; public recitation.
- Absent/weak: explicit “Socratic seminar,” explicit “scholé/restful learning.”

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 9
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage vs. classical pedagogy facets considered (chant/memory; logic/dialectic; rhetoric/orations; wonder/recitation; restful scholé named): $4/5 = 0.80$

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Note: K-12 is offered, and rhetoric/oratory is explicitly present; the absence of the specific words “Socratic” and “scholé” is outweighed by strong, directly classical practices stated for each stage.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY 1) On-site keyword findings - “Jesus-loving men and women ... helping form the souls of our children ... what’s modeled ...” (teachers as moral/intellectual models) - “Head of School who loves Jesus ... teachers ... using the classical approach” (faculty identity and formation)

2) Comparison to keyword lists

- Positive matches: teachers as models of virtue; formation through example; living curriculum; classical formation of faculty implied.
- Missing/less explicit: articulated “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty collegium/friends,” or specific ongoing classical formation programming.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 6
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage of sub-elements (model teachers; mentor/collegial culture; living curriculum; teacher/student portraits): $\sim 2/4 = 0.50$

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: Strong formational language about teachers as exemplars; fewer explicit references to a formal “portrait of a teacher” or a collegial “faculty of friends.”

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY 1) On-site keyword findings - Collaborative model: parents as “co-teachers” at home; “co-laboring with families” (parent partnership emphasized) - Parent formation: admissions step to “Read and Pray,” with both parents asked to read classical education resources; required/encouraged reading for understanding the classical approach - Access/visitation: tours include All School chapel and classroom visits; recurring prospective parent events - Community life: Recitatio showcase; athletics/theater as community-building; Grand Mustangs Club for grandparents

2) Comparison to keyword lists

- Positive matches: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent education/formation, open/hospitable campus events, intentional community – all strong according to the lexicon and “Six Elements”.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 8
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage (partnership; parent education; open campus/visitation): $3/3 = 1.00$

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment - Category ratings: - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL - Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Why: ACS hits all core classical distinctives with strong, explicit language across mission, curriculum, and pedagogy, and clearly engages parents as partners. Faculty formation indicators are positive but less fully articulated in public materials; even so, the aggregate profile is decisively classical.

What would move the needle (Faculty) - Publish a formal "Portrait of a Teacher" and/or "Portrait of a Graduate" linking teacher virtues to student formation outcomes (virtue, wisdom, rhetoric) to increase explicit coverage of faculty criteria from the classical lexicon. - Publicize ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy (e.g., great books seminars for faculty, collegium/retreats) to evidence a "faculty of friends" and formal mentorship structures.

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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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